

# Joana Pina · she/her

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## PROFILE

My background is in industrial engineering and management, but the last three years pulled me toward people, products, and growth. I **co-founded a startup and grew it to 5,000 users in under four months**, owning the product and the experience. Alongside an MBA and consulting work, I moved into AI, where I run discovery and design solutions for clients across sectors, then work with the developers who build them. I am **obsessed with making complex things simple**.

**Key interests:** Customer experience · Product & Project management · Discovery & solution design · Applied AI

## EXPERIENCE

**AI Transformation Consultant** Dec 2025 to Present

*Upgraiide Artificial Intelligence*

- Run discovery and solution design for three client companies across sectors: map how each business works, find where AI can take work off people, and shape the AI solution with the developer who builds it.
- Build demos and prototypes of each solution, for example a web-app demo for a finance team.
- Build the ROI and payback business case for every engagement, with the quantitative and qualitative benefits.
- Optimized the company's marketing with AI, from post creation to analytics and performance, with the founders.

**Co-Founder** Aug 2024 to Jan 2026

*RewU*

- Co-founded a rewards-for-attention platform and ran with it: the strategy, the go-to-market, and the partnerships.
- Owned the product end to end: the brand, the experience, and the full prototype, with the developer kept aligned to it.
- Grew the platform to 5,000 users and 50 partner companies in under four months.

**Consultant** Aug 2023 to Aug 2024

*Kaizen Institute*

- Led workshops and applied Lean tools (5S, Ishikawa, root-cause analysis) to drive continuous improvement.
- Co-developed and implemented three improvement projects, lifting process efficiency by up to 30%.
- Delivered six Value Stream Analyses in a year, contributing over €1M in EBITDA impact.

**Master's Thesis Intern** Feb 2023 to Jul 2023

*Confidencial Imobiliário*

- Conducted a Master's thesis on environmental, social and corporate-governance (ESG) factors in Portuguese real-estate pricing, using statistical tools and visualization to measure the impact.

**Process Improvement Intern** Feb 2021 to Jul 2021

*Coindu*

- Improved process quality and optimized group roadmaps by applying lean manufacturing principles.

## EDUCATION

**International MBA** Sep 2024 to Oct 2025

*Porto Business School, University of Porto · Exchange at Sasin, Thailand (2025)*

- Final Consulting Project for Natixis: designed a standardized onboarding and learning path for new credit-risk analysts, endorsed by senior leadership for implementation.
- Focus: Strategy, Innovation & Digital Strategy, Business Analytics, Communicating with Impact.

**BSc & MSc, Industrial Engineering & Management** Sep 2018 to Jul 2023

*FEUP, University of Porto · Erasmus at KIT, Germany (2021 to 2022)*

- Focus: Problem solving, Business analytics, Strategic thinking.

## SKILLS

**Product:** Product discovery · Product vision · UX/UI prototyping · Roadmapping

**AI & Solutions:** GenAI / LLM solution design · Use-case identification · ROI & payback cases

**Delivery:** Stakeholder management · Cross-functional collaboration · Project management

## LANGUAGES

Portuguese (Native) · English (C1) · Spanish (A2) · German (A1)